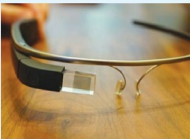


Google Glass now has a better connection to the Maps and Calendar apps

The Google Glass has reportedly made its connection with the Google Calendar and Maps apps stronger. According to reports, the search giant's wearable device can now navigate to users' workplaces and homes with a few voice commands. In addition, Google has also updated its FAQ section with a notice saying that the company won't be deactivating Glass if a user sells it. The reports came from technology portal Mashable.

According to the Mashable report, the new XE11 software update, which was announced on Google+, improves the connection between the Google Calendar and Glass. Through this, the wearers can now use simple voice commands to check their appointments. All one has to do is say, "Okay Glass, Google," followed by a command specific to the calendar, like, "What am I doing next week?" Users need to have the private search feature activated on their Google accounts, though.



With Maps, users just have to use the Directions command and say, 'Home,' for the Glass to navigate to their homes. The same can be done for the workplace. Further, the update has also fixed the issue of Google Search being activated by long pressing on the touch pad. According to reports, users had been accidentally activating the feature very often.

The controversy arises from a request by Canonical to the site maintainers of fixubuntu.com to stop using the Ubuntu logo in order to make it clear that the site is not officially affiliated with Canonical and Ubuntu and thus the site ought to get rid of the 'ubuntu' from its domain name. Steve George, vice president, Communications and Products at Canonical, expressed his opinion on the situation in a recent blog post.

However, the community response has not been very warm toward Canonical. In fact, some Ubuntu users obviously view the Ubuntu brand as something that was "...made by the community, and should be owned by the community!" It seems community users are uncomfortable with the way Canonical is deciding when and how third parties should deploy the Ubuntu trademark.

Android on 81 per cent of the smartphones shipped in Q3 2013

Android's dominance in the smartphone market continues with the OS powering four out of every five smartphones shipped in the third quarter of 2013. The information was received from the quarterly mobile phone tracker report by IDC and comes as no surprise. Google's Android operating system has been extremely popular and is fast spreading to devices other than smartphones and tablets.

In a press release issued by IDC, the organisation said, "With a total base of 211.6 million smartphone units shipped during the quarter, Android accounted for 81.0 per cent of all smartphone shipments, marking the first time that Android topped 80 per cent in its short history."

The IDC report also states that the overall smartphone market grew by 40 per cent year-on-year in Q3 despite saturation in many high profile markets. Phablet devices are reportedly a key component of the market and Android runs on almost all of them.

Now a Linux-based bicycle computer that warns you of theft

A bicycle computer, which will notify users if their bike is being stolen, has been designed by a start-up called Wi-MM. The device is known as the Bike+ BPU-100 and runs on Linux and uses a Texas Instruments processor. Its features include real time location and mapping, fleet management, route tracking and Bluetooth sync with smartphones.

Wi-MM, the firm that has developed the device, is based in Santa Clara, California. The Bike+ BPU-100 uses an accelerometer, a 3G cellular modem and cloud services in order to provide anti-theft services. The device determines when a bike is being stolen and moved and sets off an alarm while notifying the owner by a text message. Further, GPS and 3G services are used for real time location mapping, fleet management, route tracking and Bluetooth sync with smartphones, enabling the device to send continuous location updates to the bike's owner.

The device is also capable of delivering performance analytics. These include the time, speed, distance travelled and other information, which are put online and can be viewed using the Internet. In addition, the bike can also help in crash detection and sends an alert to pre selected contacts when the user has met with an accident.

Now you can send emails in your own handwriting!

Believe it or not, the era of personalised letters is back with Google's new technology that will allow you to send emails to your loved one in your own handwriting. Reportedly, Google has added a handwriting tool to Gmail and Google Docs, which will allow users to pen down their thoughts in a way that's similar to writing letters rather than keying in an email.

Users can write whatever they want with the use of the mouse pad or cursor and Google will create a typed version of the text. It will also offer suggestions for similar words, allowing users to choose from them.